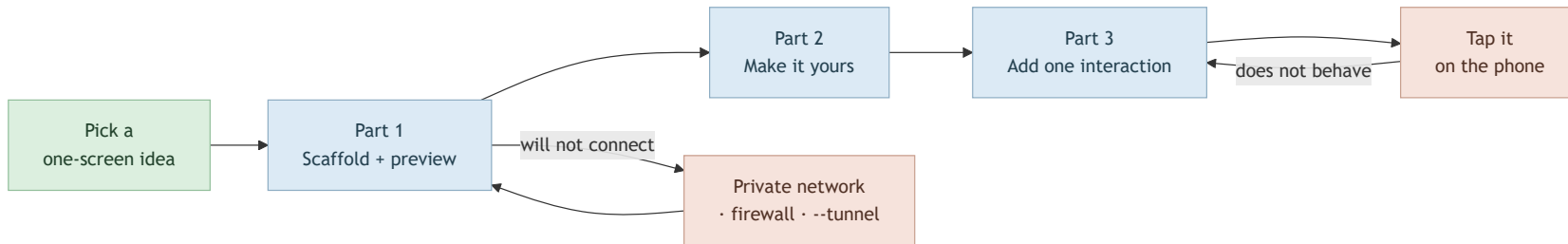


# Build and Preview a Small Mobile App

Scaffold · preview on your phone · make it yours · add one interaction

Sprint 4 — Part 2 · budget  $\approx$  1–2 hours

# The Arc



The point is to complete the full loop — nothing to running on your own phone — not to build something ambitious.

# Before You Start

Access: Claude Code open in an empty project folder.

You need:

- Node.js and npm installed (any recent version)
- The Expo Go app installed on your phone — App Store or Google Play, free
- Your phone and computer on the same Wi-Fi network

Reflection — before you scaffold anything, decide on a single-screen app idea simple enough to finish in one sitting. A tip-of-the-day screen, a list of your five favourite films, a "roll a dice" button, a countdown to a date you care about. **Keep it to one screen.**

# Part 1 · Scaffold

Access: Claude Code open in your empty project folder.

**Step 1 — Install the Expo agent skills.** First, give Claude Code current Expo context. Inside Claude Code, run:

```
/plugin install expo@claude-plugins-official
```

The plugin installs **globally** — if you already ran it earlier in the lesson, it is still active. Move straight to Step 2.

**Step 2 — Scaffold the app.** Run it yourself, or ask the agent to — either produces the same working starter:

```
npx create-expo-app@latest
```

Or paste this prompt:

```
Set up a new Expo mobile app in this folder using the standard starter template. Use the Expo skills to get the current, accurate context for building it. I want a working starter app I can preview on my phone.
```

# Part 1 · Preview on Your Phone

Access: the new project folder, scaffolded in Step 2.

**Step 3 — Start the dev server.** From inside the new project folder:

```
npx expo start
```

A QR code appears in the terminal.

**Step 4 — Open it on your phone.** On **iPhone**, scan the QR code with the Camera app. On **Android**, scan it inside the Expo Go app.

If it will not connect — set your Windows network to **Private**, allow **Node.js** through the firewall, and if all else fails run `npx expo start --tunnel` and scan the new code.

**Success check** — the starter app opens on your phone and you can see its home screen.

# Part 2 · Make It Your Own

Access: same session, dev server still running, app open on your phone.

**Step 5 — Replace the starter content with your idea.** Describe the screen you decided on. Keep the prompt about behaviour and appearance, not files:

```
Change the home screen to show my five favourite films as a clean, readable  
list. Give it a title at the top that says "My Top Five" and a calm  
background colour.
```

Watch your phone as the agent works — the screen should update on its own within a second or two of the change landing.

**Step 6 — Refine the look.** Ask for one or two adjustments in plain language until it looks the way you want:

```
Make the film titles larger and add a bit more space between each one so it  
is easier to read on a phone.
```

 **Success check** — your phone shows your own content, styled roughly the way you asked, with no red error screen.

# Part 3 · Add One Interaction

Access: same session, app still live on your phone.

**Step 7 — Add a single tappable element.** Give the screen one thing the user can do. Describe the **behaviour**, not the mechanism:

```
Add a button below my list that, when I tap it, shows a different one of my
films picked at random, with a short "tonight's pick" label above it.
```

**Step 8 — Test it on the phone.** Tap the button several times and confirm the behaviour changes each time. If it does not behave as expected, tell the agent what you see:

```
When I tap the button nothing changes on my phone. It should pick a different
film each time. Fix it.
```

**Success check** — tapping the button produces the behaviour you described, and the app still runs without errors.

# Done When

- ☐ You picked a one-screen idea you can finish in one sitting
- ☐ The Expo plugin is installed and a starter app is scaffolded
- ☐ The starter app opened on your own phone
- ☐ The home screen shows **your** content, styled the way you asked
- ☐ One tappable element works on the phone, with no red error screen

Describe behaviour and appearance — not files, not mechanisms.